

Qingqing Yang

PhD student in Experimental Psychology | The Ohio State University

Yang.6118@osu.edu | qingqing-yang-177.github.io

Research Interests

Visual attention, memory, and decision-making.

Neural mechanisms of the goal-directed behaviors in human visual system.

Integrate behavioral measurements (psychophysics, eye-tracking) and neuroimaging (fMRI, TMS).

Education

The Ohio State University, OSU 2024 – Present
Ph.D. in Experimental Psychology, Cognitive Neuroscience Program Ohio, USA

Advisors: Hsin-Hung Li, Julie Golomb

New York University, NYU 2021 – 2023
M.A. in Psychology, 3.97/4 New York, USA

Advisor: Clayton Curtis

Research Focus: How human parietal cortex contributes to the quality of working memory.

Zhejiang University, ZJU 2017 – 2021
B.Sc. in Psychology, 3.92/4 Zhejiang, China

Advisor: Hui Chen

Research Focus: The mechanism of attention guided by working memory contents.

Research Experience

Assistant Research Scientist, NYU 08/2023 – 04/2024
Advisor: Clayton Curtis

Conducted behavioral (eye-tracking) experiments on prioritization effect in working memory, while temporarily perturbed parietal cortex activity (TMS).

Assistant Research Scientist, NYU 09/2023 – 04/2024
Advisors: Catherine Hartley, Noam Goldway

Applied reinforcement learning models to quantify decision-making properties. Analyzed fMRI data to relate these properties to brain activities and clinical symptoms across development.

Publications

* denotes equal contributions.

Yang Q, Li HH (2025). Efficient Allocation of Working Memory Resource for Utility Maximization in Humans and Recurrent Neural Networks. *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*. doi:10.52202/085713-1928

Zhu P*, **Yang Q***, et al. (2023). Working-Memory-Guided Attention Competes with Exogenous Attention but Not with Endogenous Attention. *Behavioral Sciences*, 13(5), 426. doi:10.3390/bs13050426

Han H W*, Dhar R*, **Yang Q***, et al. (2024). Investigating the role of modality and training objective on representational alignment between transformers and the brain. *NeurIPS Unireps Workshop*. [html](#)

Conference Presentations & Abstracts

Yang Q*, Han H W*, Song B*, et al. (2026). Hierarchical representational transformations of working memory in brains and machines. *Spotlight poster (top 10%) at Conference on Computational Cognitive Neuroscience (CCN)*. [html](#)

Han H W, **Yang Q**, Mohsenzadeh Y (2026). Concept Manifold Geometry Explains Asymmetry in Model–Brain Bidirectional Predictivity. *Talk and Spotlight poster (top 10%) presented at CCN*. [html](#)

Yang Q, Li HH (2025). Reward Shapes Resource Allocation in Working Memory. *Poster presented at Vision Sciences Society (VSS) Annual Meeting*. [html](#)

Goldway N, Harhen N, **Yang Q**, et al (2025). Correspondence between reinforcement learning phenotypes and transdiagnostic clinical symptomatology across development. *Poster presented at CCN as Extended abstracts*. [html](#)

Goldway N, ..., **Yang Q**, et al. (2023). Reliability of a reinforcement-learning task battery for computational phenotyping of decision-making in adolescent psychopathology. *Poster presented at Computational Psychiatry Conference (cpcof)*.

Yang Q, Curtis C (2022). Effects of Interrupting Parietal Cortex Neural Activity on Working Memory Prioritization. *Talk presented at Neuromatch Conference (NMC)*.

Fellowships and Awards

Elsevier/Vision Research Travel Award, VSS	2026
Graduate Student Research Enhancement Awards (GSREA), OSU	2026
University Fellowship, OSU	2024

Professional Activities

Conference Reviewer	
Conference on Computational Cognitive Neuroscience (CCN)	2026
NeurIPS Unireps workshop	2024-2025
Teaching Assistant	
Sensation and Perception, OSU, undergrad	2026
Psychology of Creativity, OSU, undergrad	2025
Introduction to Psychology, OSU, undergrad	2025
Advanced Psychological Statistics in R, NYU, undergrad	2022